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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025

First Semester

Discipline Specific Core Course - MG1DSCCMA100 – DOCUMENTATION TOOLS AND TECHNIQUES

Time: 1.5 Hours Maximum Marks: 50

Scheme for Evaluation of Answer Scripts

Part A (Total 20 marks)

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions. Each answer carries 1 mark

1. b) Insert → Image
2. b) .pdf
3. a) Insert → Table and specify rows/columns
4. c) Impress
5. b) To present information in a visually organized manner
6. b) To maintain consistent formatting throughout a document
7. c) Right-click and choose “Edit Shape”
8. b) Changes are lost
9. a) Text Properties Panel
10. b) Preview Mode
11. a) Use regular expressions
12. c) Alignment and Distribution tool
13. a) File
14. d) To control smooth curves in vector drawings
15. b) Microsoft Word
16. a) Insert → Break → Section break
17. c) Click the image and drag the corners
18. b) Table → Table properties
19. b) Click “Share” and enter email addresses
20. a) $

Part B (Total 30 marks)

Short Answer Questions,Answer any 10 Questions

Each Question carries 3 marks

21. Explain how to apply styles and formatting to headings in LibreOffice Writer. What benefits do styles offer in document organization?

Applying Styles and Formatting to Headings (2 marks)

- Select the heading text
  Highlight the text that you want to format as a heading.

- Open the Styles Sidebar
  Press F11 or go to Styles → Manage Styles. This opens the Styles panel where all predefined styles like *Heading 1, Heading 2, Heading 3* are available.
- Apply a Heading Style
  Click on a heading style such as Heading 1 for main titles, Heading 2 for subheadings, and so on. The text immediately adopts the font size, color, spacing, and layout defined for that style.
- Modify the Style if Needed
  Right-click a style → Modify, and you can change font, alignment, spacing, and numbering. All text using that style updates automatically.

Benefits of Using Styles in Document Organization(1 mark)
(Write any 2 benefits)

- Ensures Consistent Formatting
  All headings and subheadings follow the same appearance throughout the document, improving readability and professionalism.
- Enables Automatic Table of Contents (TOC)
  Writer can generate a complete TOC instantly because heading levels (Heading 1, 2, 3…) are recognized automatically.
- Allows Quick Global Updates
  Changing a style (e.g., font size of Heading 1) updates every part of the document using that style—saving time and avoiding manual edits.
- Improves Navigation
  The Navigator tool uses heading styles to display document structure, making it easier to move between sections.
- Supports Long Document Management
  Styles help maintain a well-organized structure in long documents such as reports, project files, and dissertations.

22. Discuss the significance of page layout in document creation. What factors should be considered when choosing page orientation and size?

Significance of Page Layout in Document Creation(2 marks)

- Determines the Structure and Readability of the Document
  Page layout controls margins, spacing, orientation, and arrangement of text and images. A good layout ensures that the document is visually balanced and easy to read.
- Enhances Professional Appearance
  Well-designed layouts make reports, letters, brochures, and academic documents look organized and polished. Consistent layout improves the overall quality of the document.
- Ensures Proper Placement of Content
  Page layout decides how headings, paragraphs, tables, graphics, and charts fit onto the page. It prevents text from appearing cluttered and avoids improper page breaks.

- Improves Print and Output Quality
  Correct layout settings allow documents to print properly without text being cut off or misaligned. It ensures the document fits the selected paper size without issues.

Factors to Consider When Choosing Page Orientation and Size(1 mark)
(Write any 2 benefits)

- Purpose of the Document
  - Letters, reports, and assignments use A4 Portrait.
  - Posters, charts, and presentations may use A3 or Landscape.
    The purpose determines which orientation best suits the content.
- Type of Content
  - Wide tables, graphs, or images fit better in Landscape.
  - Continuous text works better in Portrait.
    Content shape and arrangement influence orientation choice.
- Printing Requirements and Availability
  - Printers generally support standard sizes like A4 or Letter.
  - You must consider printer margins and paper availability before finalizing layout.
- Audience and Formatting Standards
  - Academic documents follow university guidelines.
  - Business reports may follow company or industry standards.
    Following guidelines ensures the document meets expected norms.

23. What is the difference between the "Print" and "Save" options in the Mail Merge process in LibreOffice Writer?

Print Option in Mail Merge(1.5 marks)

- Directly prints the merged documents
  Once the mail merge is completed, each personalized document (for each recipient) is sent straight to the printer.
- Used for physical distribution
  Ideal when you need hard copies of letters, notices, invitations, receipts, certificates, etc.
- Output:
  Produces physical printed copies of all merged documents.

Save Option in Mail Merge(1.5 marks)

- Creates digital files instead of printing
  Each merged document is saved as a separate file in formats like *.odt*, *.docx*, or PDF.
- Used for electronic distribution or storage
  These files can be emailed, archived, or edited later.

- Output:
  Produces digital copies of the merged documents.

24. Discuss the impact of linking text frames on the flow of content in a multi-page document. (note any 3 points with brief explanation- 3 marks)
    - Linking frames allows text to flow automatically from one frame to another.
    - When content exceeds the first frame, it continues to the next linked frame.
    - Useful for magazines, newsletters, brochures.
    - Ensures dynamic content flow when text is edited or expanded.
    - Prevents overflow errors and maintains professional layout consistency.
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25. Explain the concept of kerning and tracking in typography

    Kerning(1.5 marks)

    - Kerning is the adjustment of space between specific pairs of characters.
    - Done to avoid awkward spacing, especially in combinations like AV, WA, To.
    - Improves the readability and aesthetic balance of text.

    Tracking(1.5 marks)

    - Tracking is the uniform adjustment of spacing across a range of characters or entire words/paragraphs.
    - Increasing tracking spreads the text out; decreasing it brings characters closer.
    - Used for titles, headings, and stylistic effects.

26. What are "guides" in Scribus? (3 *1= 3 marks)

    - Guides are non-printing horizontal and vertical lines used for alignment.
    - They help place text frames, images, and shapes accurately.
    - Guides appear on the workspace but do not appear in the final print.

27. Explain how to create a master page in Scribus and add a footer containing the page number and document title.

    Steps to Create a Master Page (1 mark)

    1. Go to Edit → Master Pages.
    2. Choose New Master Page or duplicate an existing one.
    3. Enter the master page editing mode.

    Adding Footer and Page Number (2 marks)

    1. Draw a text frame at the bottom area of the page.
    2. Type the document title inside the frame.

3. To insert page number:
   – Go to Insert → Character → Page Number.
4. Format the text using Properties → Text options.

Exit master page editing and apply it to any page using
Page → Apply Master Page. This makes the footer and page numbers appear on all pages that use that master page.

28. Evaluate the role of varying font sizes and colors in enhancing the readability of a document.

Role of Varying Font Sizes(1.5 marks)

1. Hierarchy Creation:
   Large sizes for headings, medium for subheadings, small for body text.
   Helps readers understand structure instantly.
2. Highlighting Important Points:
   Increases focus on key statements or important information.
3. Improved Readability:
   Proper size differentiation prevents text from looking crowded.

Role of Color Variations (1.5 marks)

1. Enhances Visual Appeal:
   Color-coded headings or keywords make the document attractive.
2. Improves Navigation:
   Readers can quickly scan through colored elements.
3. Emphasis & Clarity:
   Different colors help distinguish sections, warnings, or notes.

29. Explain how to apply and modify gradients in Scribus.

Applying Gradients (1.5 marks)

1. Select the shape or frame.
2. Open Properties → Colours.
3. Change Fill Type to Gradient.
4. Choose gradient style:
   – Linear
   – Radial
   – Conical
   – Four-color gradient

Modifying Gradients (1.5 marks)

1. Adjust start and end colors using the color picker.
2. Change angle to modify direction of the gradient.
3. Add or remove color stops to create multi-color transitions.
4. Adjust opacity levels to get transparency.

30. Write the steps to insert a chart into a Google Docs document.

Steps to Insert Chart (All the steps are correct, give 3 marks)

1. Open the document and go to Insert → Chart.
2. Choose chart type: Bar, Column, Line, Pie.
3. A default chart appears along with a linked Google Sheets file.
4. Edit the data in Google Sheets.
5. The chart in Google Docs updates automatically as sheets data changes.
6. Resize, reposition, or format the chart as needed.

31. What features of Google Docs enhance the document creation process?
(write any 6 features- 3 marks)

1. Real-Time Collaboration
   Multiple users can edit simultaneously with live updates.
2. Auto-Save & Cloud Storage
   Every change saves instantly to Google Drive.
3. Commenting & Suggesting Mode
   Useful for reviews, corrections, and teamwork.
4. Version History
   Allows restoring previous versions of a document.
5. Templates & Add-ons
   Ready-made formats for CVs, letters, reports.
6. Voice Typing & Smart Suggestions
   Speeds up writing and improves productivity.

32. How can you organize documents within Google Drive?
Methods of Organizing Documents(note these points- 3 marks)

1. Creating Folders:
   Group files by subject, project, or category.
2. Color-coding Folders:
   Helps identify important folders visually.
3. Using Drag-and-Drop:
   Move documents into folders for clean organization.
4. Applying Starred Items:
   Mark important files for quick access.
5. Using Drive Search & Filters:
   Search by file type, owner, or date to find organized documents.
6. Sharing Folders with Permissions:
   Control access and manage team collaboration.

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